Decision Memo: A 12-Month Pilot of an AI Policy-Intelligence Capability for Bangladesh

For the consideration of: the ICT Division; for information the Planning Commission, Finance Division, Legislative and Parliamentary Affairs Division, BBS and a2i · **From:** Md Naim Hassan Saykat, author of the BAPIL Technical Blueprint · **Date:** October 2026

Basis: BAPIL Technical Blueprint, Version 1.0 (10.5281/zenodo.23587901; https://github.com/md-naim-hassan-saykat/bapil). This memo is a separate document, not part of the Blueprint. CC BY 4.0.

Status. An independent research proposal, not an official document. No decision, body, host or funding exists yet.

Purpose and why now. To propose six decisions that would start, after a preparatory Phase 0, a small, safe and open pilot of an AI tool that helps officials find and cite official evidence in Bangla and English. Drafting of a national AI policy is to begin in the fourth quarter of 2026 [1], after a revised draft of February 2026 [2]; the Personal Data Protection Act, 2026 and the National Data Management Act, 2026 now frame public-sector data use [3, 4]; and official documents remain scattered, often as scanned Bangla PDFs.

Proposal. A university-anchored lab under an MoU with the ICT Division, with a Steering Board and an independent Ethics and Risk Review Committee (ERRC) whose veto binds the host as far as its statutes and the host agreement allow. Year 1 delivers **P1**, a bilingual search tool that cites official sources or abstains, piloted with 30 or more analysts; **P2**, five years of budget allocations as open data; a 500-question open Bangla benchmark; training for 100 officials; and a public transparency register. *Safeguards:* published data first; no profiling of individuals; other personal data only with consent, a DPIA and ERRC approval; a person reviews every output; hosting in Bangladesh.

Decisions proposed (from Blueprint Table 57; bodies and timings are proposals).

No.	Decision	Proposed responsible body	Proposed timing
D1	Accept the Blueprint as a technical input to national AI policy drafting	ICT Division	Q4 2026
D2	After Phase 0: approve the 12-month pilot, agree an MoU with the selected host and commit Year 1 funding (about Tk 4.7 crore)	ICT Division and host	End of Phase 0
D3	Authorise bulk access to already-public document collections; nominate data custodians	LPAD, Finance Division, Planning Commission, BBS, a2i	During Phase 0
D4	Nominate Steering Board members; select ERRC members by open call through an independent panel	ICT Division and host; independent panel	During Phase 0
D5	Fund Phase 0 (about Tk 0.44 crore, six months): open host call, independent legal review, costing study, data-access check; name a focal point	ICT Division or a development partner	Within 90 days
D6	Confirm guardrails: no deployment beyond class A without a G4 decision; no prohibited uses	Steering Board	At charter adoption

Sequence and resources. D1 and D5 come first; D2 only after Phase 0, so Month 1 can be July 2027. Indicative budget: about Tk 20.4 crore over 36 months (Tk 4.7 crore in Year 1; scenarios Tk 17.9 to 25.3 crore; adjusted Tk 22.2 crore), plus Tk 0.44 crore for Phase 0; about 9 full-time staff in Year 1, rising to 19. Planning estimates, not approved funding; the Annex W scale-up is not requested.

Evidence required before D2. Legal review of the 2026 laws (U1 to U3); the host's acceptance of the ERRC veto (U15); costing of omitted items (U16); reuse terms or bulk access (D3).

Month-12 targets (not results). P1 passes its gate (30 or more users, Recall@10 at least 0.85, citation precision at least 0.95, usefulness at least 4.0 of 5); 500 benchmark questions; five years of budget data; 100 officials trained.

Key risks. Data access (narrower corpus, assisted download); wrong answers (citations, abstention, human review); mission creep (charter prohibitions, independent veto); funding delay (only Phase 0 funded before D2).

References

References are numbered in the order in which they are first cited, and only references cited in this document are listed.

[1] THE DAILY OBSERVER. Rehan Asif Asad outlines govt's five priorities for ICT, telecom[EB/OL]. Dhaka: The Daily Observer, 2026-08-10[2026-10-20]. Available: https://observerbd.com/news/587314

[2] AI POLICY FOR BANGLADESH (aipolicy.gov.bd). Bangladesh National AI Policy 2026-2030, Draft v2, February 9, 2026[EB/OL]. Dhaka, 2026-02-09[2026-10-22]. Available: https://aipolicy.gov.bd/docs/national-ai-policy-bangladesh-2026-2030-draft-v2.0.pdf. Archived copy (Internet Archive, 2026-05-27): https://web.archive.org/web/20260527140701/https://aipolicy.gov.bd/docs/national-ai-policy-bangladesh-2026-2030-draft-v2.0.pdf

[3] GOVERNMENT OF THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF BANGLADESH. Personal Data Protection Act, 2026 (Act No. 63 of 2026)[S/OL]. Bangladesh Gazette, Extraordinary, 2026-04-10. Copy published by the ICT Division[2026-10-22]. Available: https://objectstorage.ap-dcc-gazipur-1.oraclecloud15.com/n/axvjbnqprylg/b/V2Ministry/o/office-ictd/2026/3/1c355c6a-cc9c-42a0-b07f-e0876b89dc9d.pdf

[4] GOVERNMENT OF THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF BANGLADESH. National Data Management Act, 2026 (Act No. 80 of 2026)[S/OL]. Bangladesh Gazette, Extraordinary, 2026-04-10. Copy published by the ICT Division[2026-10-22]. Available: https://objectstorage.ap-dcc-gazipur-1.oraclecloud15.com/n/axvjbnqprylg/b/V2Ministry/o/office-ictd/2026/3/ab68f686-1ba9-4c04-85ad-83f0982f7b4e.pdf